Peckers — Store Performance Review: July 2026

Prepared: 21 July 2026 · **Source:** VM Analytics exports held in the repo (`yearly_data_*` , `no_of_orders_channel_yoy_*` , `customer_metrics_yoy_*` , `net_sales_by_channel_*_10w`) **Baseline:** `docs/analysis/store-performance-analysis-2026-06.md` (30 June 2026)

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0. Data coverage & confidence — read this first

Dataset	Granularity	Coverage	Confidence
Weekly sales & channel mix (`yearly_data_*`)	Store × week	2024-04-29 → **2026-05-18** (108 wks)	High
Orders by channel (`no_of_orders_channel_yoy_*`)	Store × week × channel	2024-04-29 → 2026-05-18	**Medium — see §1**
New/return customers (`customer_metrics_yoy_*`)	Store × week	2024-04-29 → 2026-05-18	**Medium — see §1**
Product-level sales	—	Not present in these exports	Not assessable here
Daypart / hourly	—	Not present in these exports	Not assessable here

Two limits on this review, stated up front:

1. **The data ends 18 May 2026 — the same cut-off as the June report.** This review therefore does **not** update the June numbers with fresher trade. It adds analysis the June report did not perform: per-channel AOV, the customer/repeat picture, and a data-integrity audit. For current numbers, run `docs/prompts/senior-analyst-review.md` against the live database.
2. **Products and dayparts cannot be assessed from these files.** Both require live queries. They are covered in the prompt, not here.

Reconciliation check: trailing-52-week net sales computed here — Hitchin £648,429, Stevenage £904,321 — match the June report exactly, as do the commission estimates (£77k / £92k). Method is consistent; the new findings below are additive, not contradictory.

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1. Data integrity — a five-week break that invalidates part of the dashboard

This is the most urgent finding in the review, and it is not a business problem — it is a measurement problem that would cause a business mistake.

From **w/c 13 April to w/c 11 May 2026**, order counts at both stores roughly doubled with no matching increase in sales, and nearly every extra transaction was recorded as a *new customer*.

Hitchin, weekly:

Week	New cust. orders	New-cust. ATV	Total EPOS orders	Kiosk orders
2026-04-06	88	£23.70	685	193

Week	New cust. orders	New-cust. ATV	Total EPOS orders	Kiosk orders
2026-04-13	**353**	**£6.10**	**1,108**	**476**
2026-04-20	**462**	**£4.50**	**1,149**	**579**
2026-04-27	321	£8.40	999	441
2026-05-04	283	£8.70	905	405
2026-05-11	223	£8.20	812	378
2026-05-18	90	£19.90	704	224

The signature is unambiguous:

- The spike is confined to **Kiosk and Till (takeaway)** at both stores. Deliveroo, Just Eat, Uber Eats and Own Delivery order counts are flat throughout — as they would not be if this were real demand.
- **Net sales £ are unaffected.** Hitchin traded £13–14k/wk before, during and after.
- Returning-customer counts and ATV stay flat (~£21–24) the entire time. Only the new-customer line moves.
- It **self-corrected on 18 May**, snapping back to pre-break levels in a single week.

That is a till/kiosk recording change — most likely transactions being split, or a checkout flow that began creating an anonymous customer record per basket — not customer behaviour.

What this invalidates. For those five weeks, every order-derived figure on the dashboards is wrong: Total Orders, Customers, AOV (all variants), New Customer %, Delivery/In-store order share, and anything in the exception report keyed to them. Net sales, channel mix and revenue share are unaffected and remain trustworthy.

Why it matters commercially. Read at face value, April–May shows Hitchin acquiring ~370 new customers a week — a fourfold jump. Anyone reviewing that period would conclude a marketing or kiosk initiative had worked spectacularly and fund more of it. Nothing happened.

Actions: 1. Confirm what changed in the till/kiosk configuration on or about 13 April, and whether it is still in place anywhere. 2. Exclude those five weeks from any order- or customer-based reporting, or correct them at source. 3. Add the orders-vs-sales divergence check from §0 of the analyst prompt to the weekly routine — this ran undetected for five weeks and was only caught by cross-checking two datasets.

The June report said order and customer counts were "noisy" and anchored its conclusions on sales £. That was the right instinct and it protected those conclusions. But this is not noise — it is a step change with a start date, an end date and a single identifiable cause.

All order-based figures below use a "clean window": the last 12 weeks to 18 May with those five weeks removed (7 usable weeks).

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2. Trajectory — Hitchin's recovery is thinner than it looked

Net sales, per-week average, versus the matched week 364 days earlier:

Window	Hitchin	Stevenage
Last 4 weeks	£13,917/wk · **+4.8%**	£19,654/wk · **+21.9%**
Last 12 weeks	£13,121/wk · **+0.1%**	£19,524/wk · **+20.1%**

Window	Hitchin	Stevenage
Last 52 weeks	£12,470/wk · **–2.8%**	£17,391/wk · **+13.1%**

Stevenage is the cleanest story in the business: +20% or better on every horizon, and accelerating (52wk +13.1% → 12wk +20.1% → 4wk +21.9%). This is a genuine, sustained demand engine.

Hitchin needs more care than the June framing suggested. June reported "last-8-weeks YoY +4.8%" and called the recovery real. On a 12-week view Hitchin is **+0.1% — flat**. The entire recovery sits in the most recent four weeks. That is not a reason to dismiss it, but it is four data points, and the 52-week trend is still negative. Treat it as a promising signal requiring defence and confirmation, not as an established turnaround.

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3. The channel margin story — now with the missing number

The June report's central recommendation was migrating volume off aggregators. It was the right call, but it rested on commission arithmetic alone. The obvious objection — *"if we move people off Deliveroo, do they order less?"* — was unanswerable without per-channel AOV.

Per-channel AOV, clean window:

Channel group	Hitchin	Stevenage
Own delivery	**£30.51**	**£31.29**
Aggregator (Deliveroo/UE/JE)	£28.54	£30.10
In-store	£14.12	£16.27

Own-delivery baskets are larger than aggregator baskets at both stores — by £1.97 at Hitchin and £1.19 at Stevenage. So a customer moved from Deliveroo to direct ordering spends at least as much, and you keep the ~27% that currently goes to the platform. The migration has **no revenue downside** — it is pure margin recovery. That closes the objection and makes the June recommendation considerably stronger than it was when written.

What the flow is worth:

	Hitchin	Stevenage
Aggregator orders/wk (clean)	180	234
Aggregator sales, trailing 52wk	£283,762	£342,579
Est. commission @27%	~£76,600/yr	~£92,500/yr
Value of migrating 10% of those orders	**~£7,200/yr**	**~£9,900/yr**
Value of migrating 25%	~£18,100/yr	~£24,700/yr

Combined, a 10% migration is worth roughly **£17k/year** and requires no new customers, no menu change and no capital.

A correction to the June mix narrative. June reported Stevenage's channel mix as deteriorating (aggregator 25% → 35%), comparing the first 13 weeks of the series with the last 13. That drift is real, but it is a 2024-into-2025 story. Comparing the **two most recent 26-week blocks** gives a different picture:

	Aggregator share	Own-delivery share
Hitchin, prior 26wk → latest 26wk	44.8% → **42.9%**	13.1% → **14.5%**
Stevenage, prior 26wk → latest 26wk	38.7% → **37.3%**	8.3% → **9.8%**

Both stores are now drifting *slightly in the right direction*. Stevenage's slide has stopped, not continued. This does not weaken the case for the migration push — aggregator share is still 37–43% and the £170k/year leakage is unchanged — but "Stevenage's mix is deteriorating" should not be carried into the next board discussion without this qualification. The horizon you choose changes the answer, which is exactly why the prompt now requires 13/26/52-week blocks side by side.

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4. In-store AOV — the second-largest gap, and it is behavioural

Stevenage out-earns Hitchin on **every in-store channel**, while their delivery AOVs are nearly identical:

Channel	Hitchin	Stevenage	Gap
Kiosk	£14.35	£16.97	–£2.62
Till (takeaway)	£10.65	£11.89	–£1.24
Till (eat-in)	£13.26	£17.74	–£4.48
Click & Collect	£22.51	£28.97	–£6.46
Own delivery	*£30.51*	*£31.29*	*–£0.78*
Aggregator	*£28.54*	*£30.10*	*–£1.56*

The pattern is the point. On delivery — where the ordering journey is controlled by the platform and the menu is identical — the two stores are within ~£1.50 of each other. On in-store channels, where the journey is controlled by *the store*, Hitchin is £1.24–£6.46 behind on every single one.

That strongly suggests the difference is not menu, pricing or catchment. It is what happens at the counter and on the kiosk screen: upsell prompts, meal-deal positioning, whether staff ask, how the kiosk is configured.

Sizing it: Hitchin runs ~387 in-store orders/week (clean). Closing the blended in-store AOV gap (£14.12 → £16.27) is worth **~£830/week, or ~£43k/year** — at zero commission, on customers who are already in the building.

Caveat, stated honestly: part of this gap may be product-mix rather than upselling — if Hitchin skews to smaller-format items, AOV follows without anyone doing anything wrong. Confirming this needs product-level data by store and channel, which is not in these exports. It is the first thing I would check with live access. But given delivery AOVs match almost exactly, mix alone is unlikely to explain a £6.46 gap on Click & Collect.

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5. Customers and repeat rate — one myth corrected

Once the contaminated weeks are removed, the customer picture is far less dramatic than the raw data suggests — and one common assumption turns out to be false here.

Clean window (12 wks, contaminated weeks excluded)	Hitchin	Stevenage
Orders/week	293	434
New-customer ATV	£21.47	£23.96
Returning-customer ATV	£21.63	£22.43

New and returning customers spend virtually the same amount — and at Stevenage new customers spend *more*. The "£10.84 new-customer ATV" that appears if you use the raw last-12-weeks figure is entirely an artefact of the April break.

This matters for strategy. Retention is still worth pursuing, but **not** on a basket-size argument — there isn't one. The value of a returning customer here is frequency: how often they come back, not how much they spend per visit. Any loyalty proposition should be designed and measured around visit frequency, and the current data cannot measure that (it counts orders per week, not visits per customer over time). Capturing customer-level order history would unlock it.

Repeat-order share on clean weeks sits in the 55–75% band at both stores, with no clear trend in either direction over the last year.

6. Recommendations, ranked by £

#	Action	Worth	Confidence
1	**Fix the till/kiosk recording break** and add the orders-vs-sales divergence check to the weekly routine	Prevents mis-directed spend; unblocks all AOV/ customer analysis	**High**
2	**Aggregator → own-delivery migration.** Now evidenced: own-delivery baskets are *larger*, so there is no revenue downside. In-pack flyers with a direct-order code, loyalty on direct orders only	~£17k/yr at 10% migration; ~£43k at 25%	**High**
3	**Close Hitchin's in-store AOV gap** to Stevenage — audit kiosk screen flow, upsell prompts and meal-deal placement, then copy what Stevenage does	~£43k/yr	**Medium** — confirm it is not product mix first
4	**Verify aggregator menu price uplift** is actually in place. If aggregator prices match in-store prices, commission is coming straight out of margin	Immediate margin recovery if missing	**High** if absent
5	**Defend Hitchin's recovery** — but treat it as 4 weeks old, not 8. Re-check in 4 weeks before reallocating budget on the strength of it	Protects a £13–14k/wk run rate	**Medium**
6	**Renegotiate aggregator commercials** on the now-quantified £626k/yr combined volume	£12–19k/yr per 2–3pt reduction	**Medium**

7. What changed since the June report

June conclusion	Status now
~£170k/yr aggregator commission leakage	**Confirmed** — reproduced exactly
Migrating off aggregators is the biggest lever	**Strengthened** — own-delivery AOV is *higher*, so migration has no revenue cost
Hitchin recovering (+4.8%, 8 weeks)	**Weakened** — 12-week YoY is +0.1%; recovery is 4 weeks deep, not 8
Stevenage growing 20%+	**Confirmed** — +21.9% (4wk), +20.1% (12wk)
Stevenage's channel mix deteriorating	**Qualified** — true across 2 years, but the last 26 weeks show aggregator share *falling* 38.7% → 37.3%
Order/customer counts "noisy"	**Escalated** — not noise; a five-week recording break with an identifiable cause (§1)
Kiosk is the #1 in-store channel	**Confirmed**, and now sized: Hitchin's kiosk AOV runs £2.62 behind Stevenage's

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Appendix — method

- **YoY:** matched week 364 days earlier (52×7), preserving weekday alignment.
- **Clean window:** last 12 weeks to 2026-05-18 excluding w/c 2026-04-13, 04-20, 04-27, 05-04 and 05-11 → 7 usable weeks. All order-, AOV- and customer-based figures use this window. Sales-£ figures use the full window and are noted as such.
- **Per-channel AOV:** `net_sales` from `yearly_data_*_transformed.xlsx` ÷ `number_of_orders` from `no_of_orders_channel_yoy_*.xlsx`, joined on `week_commencing` and channel.
- **Aggregator** = Deliveroo + Uber Eats + Just Eat. **In-store** = Kiosk + Click & Collect + Till (eat-in) + Till (takeaway).
- **Commission** = aggregator net sales × 27% (industry blended assumption, 25–35% range; at 25% the combined figure is ~£157k/yr). Flagged as an estimate throughout.
- **Migration value** = aggregator orders/wk × aggregator AOV × 27% × migration rate × 52.
- w/c 2024-12-30 (Christmas trough) excluded from trend judgements.
- All figures computed from the repo exports on 21 July 2026 and reconciled against the June 2026 report where they overlap.